

How to Read One BLS Career Row

NAME _____

DATE _____

PERIOD _____

BLS is the **U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics**. It reports national information about jobs. The three-career table you need is already on page 4 of your IT Salary Comparison packet. You do not need to search for the numbers again.

Read one row

Software Developers: \$135,980 May 2025 U.S. median annual pay; 10% projected job growth, 2025-2035.

- **U.S.** means the whole country, not Irving or Dallas.
- **Median annual pay** is the middle yearly wage among workers in that occupation. It is not starting pay.
- **Projected growth** estimates how the number of jobs may change over ten years. It does not promise anyone a job.
- **May 2025** is the pay data date. **2025-2035** is the projection period. Keep the dates with the numbers.

Compare fairly

The three rows on packet p. 4 use the same source, place, pay measure, and dates. You can compare those numbers. A figure from Hats & Ladders or Xello may use a different place or pay measure. Read its label before comparing it with this national table.

Source: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, [Software Developers, Quality Assurance Analysts, and Testers](#), checked September 24, 2026. The class table also uses [Web Developers and Digital Designers](#).